

Architectural Case Study - CASE68

Project Name: Senior Home in Hejia Village

Design Firm: YOU+MU Architects

Location: Hejia Village, China

Total Floors: 2 Levels (derived from architectural diagrams and descriptions)

LEVEL-WISE SPATIAL PROGRAMMING

Level 1

1. Vocabulary Extraction

- Courtyard
- Corridor
- Stairwell
- Unit
- Garden
- Activity Room
- Kitchen
- Dining Room
- Toilet
- Storage Room

2. Quantity Estimation

- Courtyard 1
- Corridors approx. 2
- Stairwells 2
- Units approx. 4
- Garden 1 (front yard)
- Activity Room 1
- Kitchen 1
- Dining Room 1
- Toilets approx. 2

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- Storage Room 1

3. Spatial Relationship Description

- The courtyard serves as the central organizing element, with circulation corridors and living units surrounding it.
- Kitchen, dining, and activity rooms are grouped on the ground level for communal access.
- The front-facing garden acts as a buffer and relaxation space before entry.

4. Overall Spatial Impression

The ground level is oriented around community functions, enabling interaction among residents through an inward-facing ring layout supported by clear functional zoning.

Level 2

1. Vocabulary Extraction

- Corridor
- Stairwell
- Unit
- Balcony
- Toilet

2. Quantity Estimation

- Corridors approx. 2
- Stairwells 2
- Units approx. 4
- Balconies 1 per unit
- Toilets approx. 2

3. Spatial Relationship Description

- A central corridor loops around the floor, providing access to individual residential units.
- Balconies extend from each unit, offering outdoor exposure and views.
- Vertical circulation connects this level to the communal base below.

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4. Overall Spatial Impression

The upper level is dedicated to private living, emphasizing resident comfort and semi-outdoor connectivity through balconies.

FORMAL + ATMOSPHERIC VOCABULARY (from Photographs & Renderings)

1. Design Vocabulary Extraction

- Perforated screen
- Atrium
- Overhang
- Wooden grille
- Louver
- Glass curtain wall

2. Atmospheric Description

The visual ambiance evokes warmth and tranquility through extensive use of wood, filtered sunlight, and softened boundaries. Light, materials, and spatial proportions contribute to a gentle, serene spatial quality suited for elderly living.

3. Spatial Composition / Hierarchy

A central courtyard defines the compositional axis. Secondary spaces form a concentric spatial order around this void, with deliberate layering of privacy from exterior to interior.

4. Design Intent

The design promotes social interaction while ensuring comfort and safety. Architectural elements like screens and atriums balance privacy with openness, emphasizing a communal yet individual spatial experience.

5. Contextual Relationship

The building blends into the rural landscape through materials and scale, integrating nature into everyday living via gardens and views from private balconies.

ARCHITECTURAL ANALYTICS (from Diagrams & Construction Details)

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- Diagrams emphasize zoning around the central courtyard and a bi-directional circulation system.
- Detail drawings highlight material articulation, especially in passive lighting and ventilation strategies via perforated facades and louvers.
- Concept sketches underscore the emphasis on aging-in-place through functional simplicity and visual transparency.